



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2022-23
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (Set A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

Attempt all five questions.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of seven printed pages.

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following: [20]

- i) Write a short story entitled: "The Joy"
- ii) You were on a school trip and were on your way back to the hotel late night when your school bus, full of children, broke down in a deserted place. Describe what you saw, heard and experienced there. How was the problem solved?
- iii) "Printed books are better than E-books." Express your views either for or against this statement.
- iv) Narrate your experience of learning online during the pandemic. Mention how the experience was and also highlight few advantages and disadvantages that you and your friends had to face during online learning.

- v) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- i) Your friend has not fared well in the recent examinations. Write a letter to him/her expressing your concern. Give him/her some advice on how to score better marks and offer to help him/her to improve his/her performance.
- ii) You are concerned about the increasing cases of dengue in your locality. Write a letter to the Editor of a local newspaper highlighting the reasons for such an outbreak and suggesting measures to check the problems.

Question 3

- i) Your school is hosting an Inter-School Cookery Competition for the students of classes VII to X. Write a notice informing the students about the event. [5]
- ii) Write an e-mail to the Principal of a neighbouring school informing him/her of the event and requesting him/her to send a team of five children to participate. [5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

Every Monday, on his way back from work, Bipin Chowdhury would drop in at New Market to buy books. He had to buy at least five at a time to last him through the week. He lived alone, had few friends, and didn't like spending time in idle chat. Those who came in the evening got through their business quickly and left. Those who didn't show signs of leaving would be told around eight o'clock by Bipin Babu that he was under doctor's

orders to have dinner at eight-thirty. After dinner, he would rest for half an hour and then turn in with a book. This was a routine which had persisted unbroken for years.

Today, Bipin Babu felt that someone was observing him from close quarters. He turned round and noticed a round-faced man who now broke into a smile.

'I don't suppose you recognize me.'

Bipin Babu felt ill at ease. It didn't seem that he had ever encountered this man before. The face seemed quite unfamiliar.

"Have we met before?" asked Bipin Babu. The man looked greatly surprised.

"We met every day for a whole week. I arranged for a car to take you to the Hudroo falls. My name is Parimal Ghosh. Ranchi?"

Now Bipin Babu realized this man was making a mistake. Bipin Babu had never been to Ranchi. He smiled and said, 'Do you know who I am?'

The man raised his eyebrows and said, 'Who doesn't know Bipin Chowdhury?'

Bipin Babu turned towards the bookshelves and said, "You're making a mistake. I've never been to Ranchi."

'What are you saying, Mr. Chowdhury? You had a fall in Hudroo and cut your right knee. I brought you iodine. I had fixed up a car for you to go to Netarhat the next day but you couldn't because of the pain in the knee. Can't you recall anything? You stayed in a bungalow. You said you didn't like hotel food. One evening I had tea with you on the veranda of your bungalow. You spoke about your family. You said you had no children, and that you had lost your wife a decade ago. You always carried a bag with your books in it on your sightseeing trips. Am I right or not?'

"Which month in Nineteen fifty- eight are you talking about?" The man said, 'October.'

'No, sir,' said Bipin Babu. 'I spent October Nineteen fifty- eight with a friend in Kanpur. You're making a mistake. Good day.'

When Bipin Babu had paid for the books and was leaving the shop, the man was still looking at him in utter disbelief.

Bipin Babu's car was parked in Bertram Street. Driving up the Strand Road, Bipin Babu regretted having paid so much attention to the intruder. He clearly remembers that he had never been to Ranchi.

- i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided: [3]

1. *persisted*

- a) abandoned
- b) endured
- c) continued
- d) prescribed

2. *decade*

- a) a period of five years
- b) a period of ten years
- c) a period of twenty years
- d) a period of hundred years

3. *intruder*

- a) policeman
- b) kinsman
- c) unwanted visitor
- d) dependent person

- ii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

- a) Bipin Chowdhury loved to read books. Give two examples from the passage to justify this statement. [2]
- b) How did Bipin Babu get rid of the visitors who stayed late? [2]
- c) Quote the sentence from the passage which tells us that Bipin Babu felt uncomfortable when he encountered the intruder. [1]
- d) What strong argument did Bipin Babu give to prove that he was not in Ranchi at that time? [2]
- e) What does Bipin Babu regret? [2]

- iii) In not more than 50 words, mention what memories of the trip does Parimal Ghosh evoke to prove that Bipin Babu was indeed in Ranchi. [8]

Question 5

Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. Example: (0): disappeared [4]

The sun __(0)__(disappear) behind the clouds and the sky turned grey. The wind __(1)__(pick) up and a few drops of rain fell on the old tin roof. Jose __(2)__(run) inside and __(3)__(close) the door and all the windows. Using what little light that

came in through the cracks in the door and the windows, he __ (4) __ (fumble) around until he found the lamp and __ (5) __ (place) it on the table. With __ (6) __ (shake) hands, he __ (7) __ (light) a match. Jose looked around the small room and then at the roof. The rain had __ (8) __ (grow) stronger and together with the wind, made it sound as though it was about to blow off.

i) Fill in the blanks with appropriate words: [4]

- a) I will visit your house _____ the month of October.
- b) I was gifted a story book _____ my sister.
- c) Rina looked _____ her brother in the absence of her parents.
- d) It rained _____ four hours in the morning.
- e) High fever prevented me _____ going to the party.
- f) She is very proud and looks _____ on her colleagues.
- g) Once upon a time, the great king ruled _____ all these villages and towns.
- h) The chocolates were distributed _____ the two children.

ii) Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using *and*, *but* or *so*. Choose the correct option. [4]

1. He remained absent on Friday. It was foolish of him.

- a) It was very foolish of him to remain absent on Friday.
- b) It is foolish of him to remain absent on Friday.
- c) He remained absent on Friday and it was foolish of him.
- d) It was foolish of him to remain absent on Friday.

2. The debating teams were very happy. Both were declared joint champions.

- a) The debating team was very happy as both were declared joint champion.
- b) The debating teams were happy as both were declared joint champion.
- c) The debating teams were very happy as both were declared joint champions.
- d) The debating teams were very happy as they had been declared joint champions.

3. I will not eat. I will not sleep.

- a) Neither I will eat nor sleep.
- b) Neither will I eat or sleep.
- c) Neither will I eat nor sleep.
- d) Neither will I eat nor will I sleep.

4. The school bus drove through the gate. The clock was striking eight at that moment.

- a) When the school bus drove through the gate, the clock was striking eight.
- b) The school bus drove through the gate before the clock was striking eight.
- c) The school bus drove through the gate and the clock was striking eight at that moment.
- d) The school bus drove through the gate as the clock was striking seven at that moment.

iii) Re-write the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Make other changes that may be necessary but do not change the meaning of each sentence. Choose the correct options. [8]

1. The captain said, "It gives me great pleasure to be here this evening."

- a) The captain said that it was giving him pleasure to be there that evening.
- b) The captain said that it gives me great pleasure to be there this evening.
- c) The captain said that it gave him great pleasure to be here this evening.
- d) The captain said that it gave him great pleasure to be there that evening.

2. Very few boys are as honest as George. (End:boys.)

- a) George is more honest than other boys.
- b) George is more honest than most other boys.
- c) George is honest than many other boys.
- d) George is the most honest among other boy.

3. My mother gifted me a bag. (Begin: A bag...)
- a) A bag had been gifted to me by my mother.
 - b) A bag was gifted to me by my father.
 - c) A bag was gifted by me to my mother.
 - d) A bag was gifted to me by my mother.
4. As soon as the Manager arrived, the meeting started. (Begin: No sooner...)
- a) No sooner did the Manager arrive than the meeting started.
 - b) No sooner did the Manager arrive when the meeting started.
 - c) No sooner did the Manager arrive, the meeting started.
 - d) No sooner did the Manager arrived than the meeting started.
5. In spite of trying well, the athlete lost the race. (Begin: Despite...)
- a) Despite of trying well, the athlete lost the race.
 - b) Despite trying well, the athlete lost the race.
 - c) Despite trying well, the athlete did not lose the race.
 - d) Despite trying well, he lost the race.
6. I spoke to my teacher before choosing the subjects. (Begin: I chose)
- a) I chose the subjects while speaking to my teacher.
 - b) I chose the subjects before speaking to my teacher.
 - c) I chose the subjects after speaking to my teacher.
 - d) I chose the subjects because I spoke to my teacher.
7. She is too slow to finish the work on time. (Use: 'so')
- a) She is so slow to finish the work on time.
 - b) She is so slow that she can finish the work on time.
 - c) She is so slow that she cannot finish the work on time.
 - d) She is so slow because she cannot finish the work on time.
8. Unless he writes the letter, they will not start the project. (Begin: If...)
- a) If he writes the letter, they will not start the project.
 - b) If he writes the letter, they will start the work.
 - c) If he does not write the letter, they will start the project.
 - d) If he writes the letter, they will start the project.